

Likhatu — User Guide

Likhatu is a browser-based writing tool for long-form academic and technical writing. Everything is stored locally in your browser — no account, no server, no cloud sync.

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1. Getting Started

Open Likhatu in your browser. Your data lives in `localStorage` under the `likhatu_*` keys — it persists across page reloads but is tied to the browser profile you use.

Minimum browser width: 768 px (designed for desktop use).

2. Library

The Library is the home screen. It lists all your articles.

Creating an article

Click + **New Article**, type a title, and press **Enter** or click **Create Article**. You are taken directly to the editor.

Article cards

Each card shows:

- Title (click to open in editor)
- Word count and last-modified date
- Reference count (if any)
- A two-line content preview

Per-article actions

Three buttons sit at the right of each card:

Button	Action
Refs	Open the reference list for that article
Focus	Launch a focus timer session for that article

Delete	Asks for confirmation before deleting
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Search and sort

- The search box filters articles by title and content in real time (300 ms debounce).
- The sort dropdown orders by **Modified** (default), **Created**, **Word Count**, or **Title**.

Navigation

- **Global Refs** — view and manage references across all articles
- **Corpus** — manage your research document library
- **Settings** — configure AI providers, theme, and backups

3. Editor

Click an article title to open it. The editor is a full-featured Markdown editor with a live toolbar.

Title

The title field is at the top. Changes are saved immediately to the database.

Toolbar

The toolbar provides one-click formatting:

Button	Markdown	Notes
B	**bold**	
<i>/</i>	<i>*italic*</i>	
H1 / H2 / H3	# / ## / ###	
List	- item	Unordered
Num	1. item	Ordered
</>	```code```	Code block
"	> quote	Blockquote
Image	![alt](url)	Opens image picker (see below)

Keyboard shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl+S	Save now
Ctrl+B	Bold
Ctrl+I	Italic
F11	Toggle fullscreen editor

Auto-save

Content is saved automatically 3 seconds after you stop typing. The NLP snapshot is also recorded at that point.

Image insertion

Click the **Image** toolbar button. You can:

- **Paste a URL** — enter any public image URL.
- **Upload a file** — click "Choose file" to embed an image from disk. The image is stored locally in the browser and referenced with a `likhatu-img://` scheme so it travels with your backup file.

Preview mode

Click **Preview** (top-right of the editor header) to render the Markdown — including tables, superscript (`^text^`), subscript (`~text~`), and inline references (`[@shortcode]`). Click **Edit** to return to the editor.

Superscript and subscript (in Markdown)

Use `^text^` for superscript and `~text~` for subscript. These render correctly in preview mode. In the WYSIWYG variant (LongForm-W), use **Ctrl+.** for superscript and **Ctrl+,** for subscript via the formatting toolbar.

In-text citations

Type `[@shortcode]` anywhere in the text to insert an in-text citation. The shortcode must match a reference you have added under **Refs** for that article. The preview renders the citation in the article's selected citation style.

4. Writing Analysis (NLP Panel)

Click **Analysis** in the editor header to open the NLP panel.

The panel shows metrics computed from the last save:

Metric	What it measures
Word count	Total words
Readability	Flesch-Kincaid grade level
Passive voice	Percentage of sentences using passive construction
Hedge words	Percentage of sentences containing hedging language (e.g., "might", "possibly")

Scores update each time the auto-save fires or you click **Save Now**. The panel also shows a sparkline history of word count across recent saves.

5. AI Research Assistant

Click **Research** in the editor header to open the research panel.

How it works

Type a question or search term and press **Enter** or click **Ask**. The assistant receives your article title and the first 500 characters of your content as context, then streams a response.

If you have corpus documents tagged (see §7), you can filter by tag — those documents are included in the context when using a local (Ollama) provider.

Providers

Select the provider in the panel or configure a default in Settings:

Provider	Requires
OpenAI	OpenAI API key
Claude	Anthropic API key
Ollama	Ollama running locally; no API key needed

Research source

- **Web** — uses the configured cloud provider (OpenAI or Claude).
 - **Local** — forces Ollama regardless of the default provider; corpus tag filtering is active.
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6. References

Each article has its own reference list. There is also a **Global References** list accessible from the Library header, which aggregates references from all articles.

Opening references

From the Library, click **Refs** on an article card. From the editor header, click the **Refs** link.

Importing from DOI

Paste a DOI (e.g., 10.1038/nature12345) or a full https://doi.org/... URL into the import box and press **Enter** or click **Import**. Likhatsu fetches metadata from CrossRef and populates all fields automatically.

Adding manually

Click + **Add Manual** to create a blank reference card and fill in the fields:

- Shortcode (used in [@shortcode] citations)
- Title, Authors (semicolon-separated), Year
- Journal, Volume, Issue, Pages
- DOI, URL

Click **Save** on the card.

Tags

Each reference can carry one or more tags. Click **+** **tag** on a reference card, type a label, and press **Enter**. Tags can be used to filter in the Global References view.

Exporting BibTeX

Check the references you want to export (use **Select All** if needed) and click **Export BibTeX**. A `references.bib` file is downloaded.

Global references

The Global Refs view shows references from every article. A badge on each card shows the source article name. Use the search box to filter by tag or article title.

7. Corpus

The Corpus is a library of reference documents (papers, notes, PDFs) that the AI research assistant can draw from when using the Local provider.

Adding a URL source

1. Enter the source URL.
2. Optionally add tags by typing in the tag field and pressing **Enter** for each.
3. Click **Add**.

Uploading a file

Supported formats: **plain text (.txt)**, **PDF (.pdf)**, and **MEDLINE (.nbib / .txt MEDLINE format)**.

1. Click **Choose File** and select a file.
2. A confirmation panel appears showing the filename.
3. Add tags if desired, then click **Import** (or **Cancel** to discard).

MEDLINE files may contain multiple records and are imported as a batch.

Tagging and filtering

Tags let you scope which documents the AI sees during a research query. In the Research panel, select one or more tags under **Filter by tag** — only matching corpus documents are included in the prompt context.

Removing documents

Each corpus card has a **Delete** button with a confirmation step.

8. Focus Mode

Focus Mode provides a distraction-free writing timer.

Starting a session

From the Library, click **Focus** on an article card. Choose a preset duration:

- 15, 30, 45, 60, or 90 minutes

- **Custom** — type a duration like 25 , 25m , or 90s and press **Enter** or click **Start**

Clicking Start takes you back to the editor with a countdown chip visible in the header.

During a session

- The chip in the editor header shows the remaining time.
- Click ← **Back to Editor** (on the Focus screen) to return to writing without ending the session.
- Click **End Session** to stop the timer early.

When time is up

A nudge appears prompting you to keep going or end the session. Clicking **End Session** returns you to the Library with a "Session complete!" confirmation.

Browser notes:

- Fullscreen is requested automatically when a session starts (requires a user gesture).
- Wake lock (screen stays on) is supported in Chrome and Edge.
- Session state is not persisted across page reloads.

9. Settings

Open Settings from the Library header.

Appearance

Switch between **Dark** (default) and **Light** theme. The change applies immediately.

AI Provider

Choose which provider the Research panel uses by default:

- **OpenAI** — paste your sk-... key in the OpenAI section.
- **Claude (Anthropic)** — paste your sk-ant-... key in the Claude section.
- **Ollama (Local)** — enter the base URL (default: http://localhost:11434) and model name. Click **Fetch Models** to populate a dropdown from your running Ollama instance. No API key is required.

Click **Save Settings** to persist. API keys are stored only in your browser's localStorage and never leave your device.

10. Backup & Restore

Likhatu stores up to **three backup slots** in the browser. Each slot captures the full database, settings, and all embedded images.

Manual backup

Go to **Settings → Backup & Restore** and click **Backup Now**. The newest slot appears in the list labelled "Latest".

Downloading a backup

Click **Download** next to any slot. A `.likhatu` file is saved to your downloads folder. Keep this file somewhere safe — it is a complete snapshot of your data.

Auto-backup

Set an interval in the **Auto-backup interval** dropdown:

- Off (default), Every 15 min, Every 30 min, Every hour, Every 6 hours

When all three slots are full, the oldest is dropped automatically.

Restoring from a file

Click **Restore from File**, select a `.likhatu` file, and the app reloads with the restored data. The current state is overwritten, so back up first if needed.

Data & Privacy

- All data is stored locally in your browser (`localStorage`).
- API keys are never sent anywhere except directly to the provider's API endpoint.
- Clearing browser storage or site data will erase your articles. Use backups regularly.
- Likhatu runs entirely offline except when making AI research queries or importing DOI metadata.